



Vanquish hits Steam

One of the most popular console only shooter games, Vanquish, finally comes to Steam. <http://digit.in/Vanquish1>



Meat-eating sponge

Canadian researchers have discovered a new species of meat-eating sponge in the North Atlantic Ocean. <http://digit.in/SpongeM>

BUILD AND DESIGN



Samsung Galaxy S8

Price: ₹57,900

You've probably read this over a million times by now, but it's still true: the Samsung Galaxy S8 is a beautiful smartphone. Samsung has made five such smartphones now and 2017's effort is definitely the best. The basic design language remains the same as last time, with curves on the front and back and glass all around. Combining its new elements, the Galaxy S8 is definitely the most beautiful smartphone today. The use of univisium aspect ratio allows for a tall and narrow phone, which is ergonomic and hence easy to use. So, even with a rather large 5.8-inch display, the Galaxy S8 is not much bigger than most other 5.5-inch smartphones. Combined with the curved screens, this makes for a design that's bezel-less for all practical purposes. Every design choice here is meant to make the phone ergonomic, including the use of on-screen buttons. That said, Samsung's design is not without flaws. Glass all around makes it precarious, slippery and easy to break. The fingerprint sensor placement is simply too awkward to get used to, especially on the bigger S8+. You'll most likely be buying a case for this phone, which pretty much negates its impressive design.



LG G6

Price: ₹51,990

The LG G6 also uses univisium aspect ratio like the Galaxy S8, and like that phone it is tall and narrow. So, despite a 5.7 inch display the LG G6 is a comparatively ergonomic smartphone. However, it doesn't have the flashy head turning looks of the Galaxy S8, which may be a downer for flagship phone buyers. It's still distinctive though, with rounded corners and a metal+glass design, that looks distinctive.

With the G6, LG is finally embracing industry standards and truth be told, we aren't very happy about it. The company has always been one of the more daring ones in terms of design, but it seems last year's failure with the G5 was enough of an eye opener. It's good to learn from past mistakes of course, but quite another to simply conform though.

There's still a bit of the LG we know here. The design may not turn heads, but it's truly functional. The metallic frame makes it sturdier, and rounder corners bring just the right touch for a unique facade. While the G6 feels sturdy, glass on both sides makes it almost as precarious as the Galaxy S8. It's not as slippery, but you'd still want to be careful at most times.



Sony Xperia XZs

Price: ₹49,990

The upright, rectangular stance is complemented by rounded edges, lending smooth symmetry to the smartphone. There is a neat flow of symmetry about the device, with the physical power button to the middle of the right edge integrating the fingerprint sensor. The volume rocker and the camera button are placed to the lower end of the right edge, which contributes to ergonomics. One-handed usage is easy, aided by the compact body. Of the three phones in this comparison, the Xperia XZs is the only one that's not prone to breaking on the first drop. However, it's the exact same design we saw last year on the Xperia XZ. Metal on the Xperia XZs will possibly be scratched on consecutive drops, but glass on the other two will break.

Our Xperia XZs review unit picked up some abrasions on the edges along the way, but it's a decently built device. The phone is symmetric, easy to use with one hand and would qualify as a functional design like the LG G6. The Sony Xperia XZs practically retains the same overall design that Sony labels as 'Loop'. While this may be the same as its previous smartphones, it still stands out among other smartphones.